

SKOAR!

MotoGP 14

One for the MotoGP loyalists

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MotoGP has always been the window into Grand Prix motorcycle racing. With the advent of next-gen (or so they call it) hardware like the PS4, developers have started pushing things up a notch and MotoGP 14 is a result of that. MotoGP 14 includes all the real-world teams, riders and race circuits exactly as seen in the recent MotoGP World Championship 2014. Not only that, the game also incorporates Moto2 and Moto3 classes along with the premier MotoGP class. To say the truth, we didn't have any big expectations from



the game considering it was exactly based on the professional motorsport franchise but as it turns out, we were underestimating it, that too by quite a big margin.

Our experience with the racing genre of games has largely been with 4-wheeled vehicles and maybe this is why while playing MotoGP 14 we felt that we were trying to ride a two-wheeled missile and

control it in the process on a race track. We say this because when we first tried out a quick race, it was really difficult to control a 1,000 CC bike while navigating a race course and we fell down at corners, were thrown into the air and slipped out to the sides plenty of times (more times than we would like to accept). But this is where the beauty of MotoGP 14 lies and what it tries to convey is that you need to maintain a great deal of control if you want to enjoy the game. It's only after firing up the career mode we noticed that we could take a grip of this game. The career mode puts you into Moto3 instead of directly putting you on MotoGP. And from here you progress into Moto2 and then finally into MotoGP. The bikes in Moto3 seem to provide better grip to the tarmac and the dynamics of understeer are hardly visible due to the fact that the bikes are slow and easy to control.

In terms of gameplay elements, the developers have thrown-in a "rewind" feature which is reminiscent of the "Dirt" series of games. Each race starts off in the garage or the pit where you can take help from your teams engineer and understand which part of your bike works how or tweak parts of your bike. You can also upgrade your bike with parts that are unlocked depending upon your performance on the track. But these turn out to be a gimmick since they hardly ever realistically affected the bike's performance.

MOAR!

Developer: Milestone S.r.l;

Publisher: Milestone S.r.l;

Genre: Racing;

Platform: PC, PS3, PS4, PSVita, Xbox 360;

Mode: Single-player, Co-op; Online Multiplayer

Age Rating: PEGI 3 (Provisional)

Price (On Steam): ₹2,400

Since MotoGP 14 is essentially a racing simulator, we see an incredible amount of work done when it comes to the in-game physics. The graphics for instance including for the bikes and the circuits look really good but unfortunately these are let down by lacklustre environments which make the game look dated. The atmosphere inside the game simply isn't immersive enough to satiate the appetite of today's gamers. The in-game sound on the other hand, if put plainly is bad; so much so that you would feel all of it is purely made by amateurs using a bad synthesizer. Revving up the engine or braking doesn't sound natural at all which further ticks all the wrong boxes for the game for us.

Different race modes like "Real events", "Challenge the champions", "Time Attack" and "Safety Car" make things interesting but they're not quite enough to rid the game of monotony. If you're someone who gravitates towards

the professional bike-racing genre and likes pro-style handling then MotoGP 14 is for you.

Read the complete review of the game online here: <http://digit.in/motogp14review>. *

